

Address Formats

Address formats in Dynamics 365 are essential tools for ensuring that addresses are properly structured, displayed, and stored according to the specific requirements of different countries, regions, or even fantastical settings like Faerûn. The address format determines how different components (such as street, city, postal code, and country) are organized when addresses are entered or displayed in the system. By configuring address formats, businesses and organizations can maintain consistency, improve data accuracy, and cater to local or specialized needs across multiple regions or dimensions.



Purpose of Address Formats

The primary purpose of address formats in Dynamics 365 is to ensure that addresses are structured according to the conventions or standards of the regions being represented. This ensures that:

Consistency: All addresses entered into the system follow a predefined structure, avoiding confusion caused by differences in regional address standards.

Localization: Different countries and regions have unique ways of formatting addresses. By using address formats, the system can accommodate regional variations such as postal code placement or special address components.

Operational Efficiency: Structured and consistent address formats aid in smooth operations for shipping, billing, and other logistical tasks. They ensure that addresses can be processed without errors, making operations more reliable.

User Experience: Displaying addresses in a familiar format for users in specific regions enhances the user experience. When users interact with their addresses, seeing them in a local format provides familiarity and clarity.

Specialized Formats: In specialized environments like Faerûn or other non-traditional settings (such as interplanar addresses in the Astral Sea), address formats allow the system to account for unique place names, cities, and geographical structures that wouldn't fit typical real-world formats.

How Address Formats are Configured

In Dynamics 365, address formats are configured by defining the individual address components and specifying the order in which they should appear. Components such as street, city, state, postal code, and country are arranged based on local conventions or specialized needs.

Each component is selected from a list and configured with additional settings, such as:

Separator: Characters or spaces that separate each component.

New Line: Indicates whether a component should start on a new line.

Expand: Determines if the field should expand to display more information.

Example Address Formats

Here are some examples of Address Formats that may be required.

Modern Address Format (USA)

A standard U.S. address format is typically configured as:

Format	Example
Street Number and Name	1234 Main Street
City, State Postal Code	Springfield, Illinois 62704
Country	United States

This structure is familiar to users from North America and is critical for tasks like shipping, billing, and regional identification.

European Address Format (France)

European countries like France may use a different address structure, particularly in the placement of the postal code before the city name. A typical address format for France might be configured as:

Format	Example
Street Name and Number	10 Rue de Rivoli
Postal Code	75001
City	Paris
Country	France

This format reflects the unique European convention where postal codes precede the city name.

Faerûn

In the Faerûn region of the Forgotten Realms, address formats may reflect a hierarchy of districts, cities, and regions due to the diverse range of settlements. An address format for Waterdeep might look like:

Format	Example
Street Name	Street of the Singing Dolphin
District Name	North Ward
City Name, Region/Province Name	Waterdeep, Sword Coast North
Country Name	Faerûn

In contrast, smaller cities or frontier regions might include fewer components, such as a village name and region.

Astral Sea (Planar Addressing)

In more specialized or fantasy settings, like the Astral Sea from the Dungeons & Dragons multiverse, addresses could incorporate magical or planar elements, such as specific portals or layers. A hypothetical Astral address might be:

Format	Example
Portal/Way Number	Portal #112 (to Mechanus)
Region or Plane Name	The Lady's Ward
Planar Reference (e.g., layer or demiplane)	Sigil, The City of Doors, Astral Sea

This format would cater to non-traditional planar travel and representational requirements within a multiversal structure.

Zakhara (Land of Fate)

In Zakhara, address formats may emphasize titles, districts, and landmarks, important in a land of desert cities and coastal ports. An address format could be structured as:

Format

Building Name or Title

Street or District

City, Region Name

Example

Palace of the Pearl Sultan

Spice Market

Huzuz

Golden Gulf, Zakhara

This format prioritizes notable landmarks and titles within the bustling cities of Zakhara.

Summary

Address formats in Dynamics 365 offer significant flexibility, allowing organizations to adapt the system to meet the unique needs of various regions, cultures, or specialized settings. Whether dealing with real-world geographical regions or fantasy-based locations like Faerûn or the Astral Sea, configuring proper address formats ensures accurate data capture, operational efficiency, and a more user-friendly experience across all regions or realms.

Opening the Address setup maintenance page

Overview

We will configure the address format details and address defaults, such as the countries, cities, provinces, and districts within the **Address setup** page within the system.

Let's start by learning how we can access the **Address setup** maintenance page within the system, and then we can start setting up the address configurations for our organization.

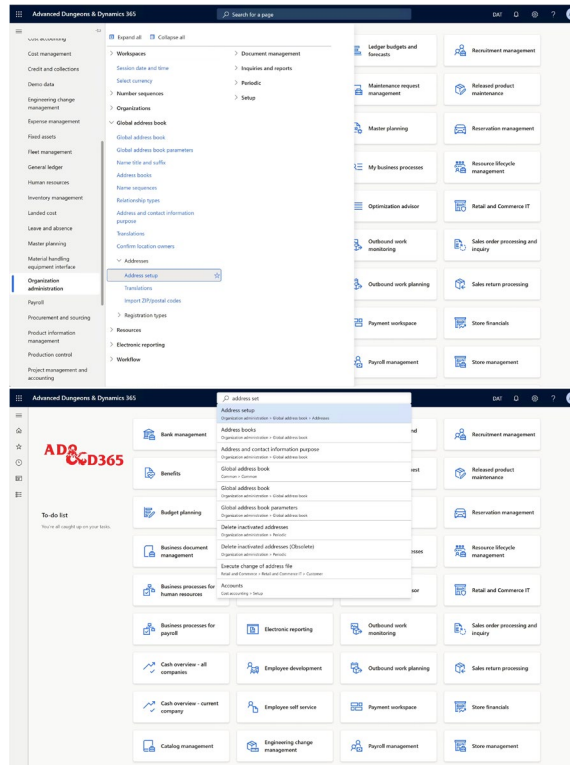
To open the Address Setup maintenance page, follow these steps:

1. Click on the **Hamburger icon** () to open the navigation menu and expand the **Modules** group. Then click on the **Organization administration** group to see all the available menu items. Now click on the **Address setup** menu item within the **Addresses** folder of the **Global address book** group.
2. Click on the **Search box** () in the header of the page (or press ALT+G) and then type "addre set" into the search to search for the **Address setup** page. When the search results are returned, select the **Address setup (Organization administration > Global address book > Addresses)** item from the list.

How to do it...

To open the Address Setup maintenance page, follow these steps.

To access the **Address setup** maintenance page using the navigation menu, we begin by clicking the **Hamburger icon** (☰) in the top-left corner to expand the navigation menu. Once the menu is open, we scroll down to the **Modules** section and click on **Organization administration**. This reveals several groups of items; we locate and expand the **Global address book** group, then find and open the **Addresses** folder. Finally, we click the **Address setup** option to access the maintenance page.



To access the **Address setup** page through the menu search feature in Dynamics 365, we start by using the search function located in the header. We can either click on the **Search box** (🔍) or press **ALT+G** on our keyboard to activate it. Once the search bar is ready, we type "**addre set**"—a shortened version of the page's name—into the field. As we type, the system quickly retrieves related results. From the search results, we select the **Address setup (Organization administration > Global address book > Addresses)** option. This approach offers a faster way to navigate directly to the **Address setup** page, without needing to browse through the various menus.

Result

Upon opening the **Address setup** maintenance page, we will be able to view and manage all existing address structures in the system. The left panel lists various address categories, such as country/region, state/province, and city, while the main panel allows users to input an address format and description. The page also provides options to configure address components, such as adding, removing, or reorganizing elements of the address format.

This form helps structure and address details for accurate data entry and management.

The screenshot shows the 'Address setup' page in the Advanced Dungeons & Dynamics 365 application. The page is divided into several sections:

- Left Panel:** A sidebar with a 'Standard view' dropdown and a list of address categories: Address format, Country/region, State/province, County, City, District, Street, Group of houses, Land plots, Group of flats, and ZIP/postal codes. 'Address format' is currently selected.
- Main Panel:** Titled 'Enter address format information for address setup'. It includes a toolbar with '+ New', 'Delete', 'Save', and 'Update addresses'.
- Table:** A table with columns 'Address fo...' and 'Description'. It is currently empty.
- Form Fields:** On the right, there are input fields for 'Address format' (with a red asterisk indicating a required field) and 'Description'. A 'Preview' box is also present.
- CONFIGURE ADDRESS COMPONENT:** A section with '+ Add', 'Remove', 'Up', and 'Down' buttons. Below it is a table with columns: Address application object, Separator, New line, Data entry only, Not active, Expand, and Special. The table is currently empty, showing a message: 'We didn't find anything to show here.'

Creating a Default Faerûn Address Format

Overview

Faerûn is broken up into multiple regions (like the Sword Coast), equating to States within the system. The country has not embraced the concept of Postal codes right now, so they will not be necessary. And cities are broken down into Wards which we will configure as Districts within the address format.

With that said, none of the existing Address formats that are configured in the system allow us to format an address with just this information showing.

For example, here is a sample Faerûn address:

Phalantars Philters & Components
Cats Alley
Castle Ward, Waterdeep
Faerûn

So, before we create our new country and regional information, we will want to build a new Address format just for the Faerûn addresses to display accordingly.

To configure a default Address Format for the Faerûn localization, follow these steps:

1. Click on the **Address format** tab section.
2. Click on the **New** button within the **Address format** section header.
3. Enter an **Address format** code into the **Address format** field.
4. Enter a description of the **Address format** into the **Description** field.
5. Click on the  (**Save**) button in the menu bar.
6. Click on the **Add** button within the **Configure Address Component** section of the page.
7. Click on the **Address application object** dropdown list and select "**Zip/postal code**" from the dropdown list.
8. Check the **New line** box.
9. Click on the **Add** button within the **Configure Address Component** section of the page.
10. Click on the **Address application object** dropdown list and select "**State**" from the dropdown list.
11. Enter " " into the **Separator** field.
12. Click on the **Add** button within the **Configure Address Component** section of the page.
13. Click on the **Address application object** dropdown list and select "**City**" from the dropdown list.
14. Enter ", " into the **Separator** field.
15. Click on the **Add** button within the **Configure Address Component** section of the page.
16. Click on the **Address application object** dropdown list and select "**District**" from the dropdown list.
17. Check the **New line** box.
18. Click on the **Add** button within the **Configure Address Component** section of the page.
19. Click on the **Address application object** dropdown list and select "**Street**" from the dropdown list.

Default Faerûn Address Format (DEFAULT)

Address application object	Separator	New Line
Street		✓
District		✓
City	,	
State or province		
ZIP/postal code		✓
Country/region		

20. Check the **New line** box.
21. All we need to do is click on the  **Save** button in the menu bar.

How to do it...

To configure a default Address Format for the Faerûn localization, follow these steps:

To begin setting up the address format for **Faerûn**, we first need to navigate to the **Address format** section in the **Address setup** page within Dynamics 365. This section allows us to define and manage all address formats used throughout the system.

If we aren't already on the **Address format** tab, we need to select it. This will bring up the screen where we can create a new **Address format record**, which will be tailored to the unique address structure of Faerûn.

By ensuring this tab is selected, we're now ready to configure the address format that will reflect **Faerûn's** regions and wards.

To create a new address format in the **Address format** tab within the **Address setup** form, begin by clicking on the **New** button located in the **Address format** section header. This will start the process of configuring a custom address format, allowing us to define the way address details are displayed, as well as which fields are required when entering this type of address.

By doing this, we can ensure that the address format aligns with the specific needs of our system or organization.

After creating a new address format record in the **Address setup** form, we proceed to configure the specific details for this format. The first step is to assign a unique code to the format that can be used for lookup and reference. In the **Address format** field, we enter **FAE** as the code. This designation ensures that the system will consistently recognize and apply this address format when working with related addresses, adhering to the Faerûn standard for formatting. With this code in place, we are ready to configure additional address components.

With the **Address format** code now set to **FAE**, the next step in configuring the Faerûn address format is to provide a detailed description. This helps users quickly identify the format and understand its purpose. We enter **Default Faerûn Address Format** in the **Description** field, making it clear that this configuration is intended for standard Faerûn addresses.

By adding this descriptive text, we ensure that anyone accessing this record knows exactly when and how to apply this specific format, promoting consistent use throughout the system.

After entering the key details for the new Faerûn address format, including the **FAE** code, a descriptive label, and the first address component, **Country/region**, we are ready to commit these changes to the system. By clicking the **Save** button in the menu bar, we ensure that this configuration is securely stored.

This step finalizes the creation of the address format, making it available for use across the system whenever Faerûn-specific addresses are needed. Saving the format now allows us to build upon it further by adding more components, if necessary, or applying it to relevant records.

After saving the initial details of the Faerûn address format, we move on to building out the full address structure. The **Country/region** component has been added by default, but to ensure the address is fully configured, we need to include additional components such as the city, state, and postal code.

To do this, we click the **Add** button in the **Configure Address Component** section. This action opens the option to add more address elements, allowing us to customize the format to match the specific requirements for Faerûn addresses.

By adding these components, we ensure that all address fields are available and displayed in the correct order when users enter address data.

To begin building the Faerûn address format from the bottom up, we first add the **Zip/postal code** component. This method helps us avoid having to reposition each element after it's added. Start by clicking the **Address application object** dropdown list. From the list of available options, select **Zip/postal code**. This ensures that postal code information will be captured in the address format, forming the foundation for our address structure.

The screenshot shows the 'Address setup' form in Dynamics 365. The 'Address format' is set to 'FAE'. The 'Description' field contains 'Default Faerûn Address Format'. The 'Configure Address Component' section shows 'Country/region' as the first component.

The screenshot shows the 'Address setup' form in Dynamics 365. The 'Address format' is set to 'FAE'. The 'Description' field contains 'Default Faerûn Address Format'. The 'Configure Address Component' section shows 'Country/region' as the first component, and 'City' has been added as the second component.

The screenshot shows the 'Address setup' form in Dynamics 365. The 'Address format' is set to 'FAE'. The 'Description' field contains 'Default Faerûn Address Format'. The 'Configure Address Component' section shows 'Country/region' as the first component, 'City' as the second, and 'State/province' as the third component.

The screenshot shows the 'Address setup' form in Dynamics 365. The 'Address format' is set to 'FAE'. The 'Description' field contains 'Default Faerûn Address Format'. The 'Configure Address Component' section shows 'Country/region' as the first component, 'City' as the second, 'State/province' as the third, and 'Zip/postal code' as the fourth component.

After adding the **Zip/postal code** component to the address format, we configure it to display on a separate line. To do this, we check the **New line** box for the **Zip/postal code** component.

This ensures that when addresses are displayed, the postal code will appear on a new line, improving the readability and structure of the Faerûn address format.

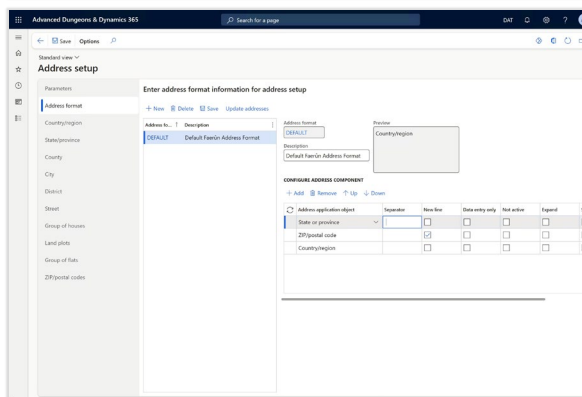
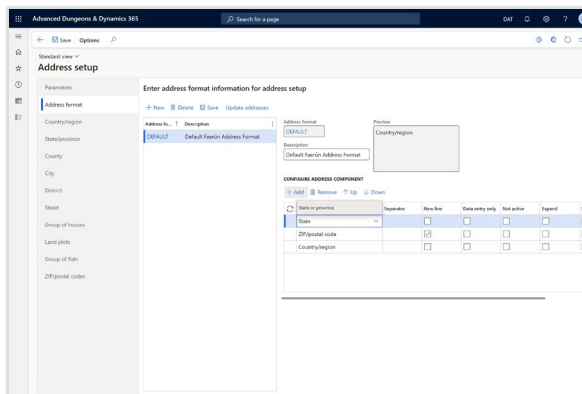
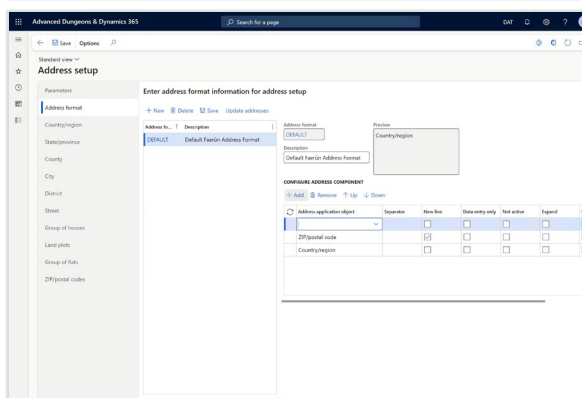
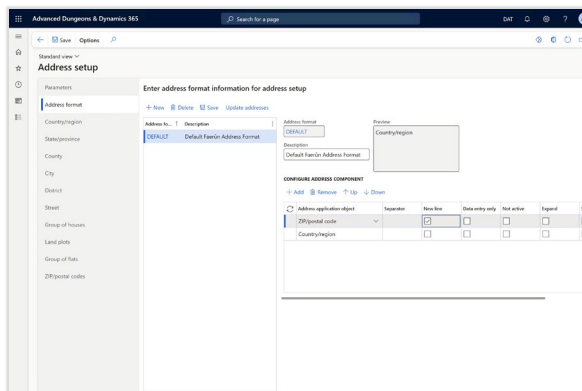
With the **Zip/postal code** and **Country/region** components added to the Faerûn address format, the next step is to include more key address components. Since we are working from the bottom up, we now need to add the **State/province** component to the format.

To do this, we click the **Add** button in the **Configure Address Component** section. This allows us to select and include the **State/province** field, ensuring that this important information is part of the address layout.

By adding these components in sequence, we are creating a comprehensive and structured address format that captures all the necessary details.

As we continue configuring the Faerûn address format, we proceed by adding the **State** component. Since we are working from the bottom of the address up, this step ensures that each component is added in the correct order without needing to rearrange them later. To add the state or province information, we click on the **Address application object** dropdown and select **State** from the list of available options. This allows us to capture and display state or provincial information as part of the address, moving us closer to a complete address structure.

As we continue to structure the Faerûn address format, we ensure that the **State or province** and **Zip/postal code** components are properly separated for readability. Since the zip code will follow the state in the address, we add a space between these two fields. To do this, we enter a blank space in the **Separator** field for the **State or province** component. This will ensure that when the address is displayed, there is a clear separation between the state and zip code, enhancing the format's clarity and usability.



As we continue refining the Faerûn address format, we need to add more components to ensure all key address details are captured. With **State or province**, **Zip/postal code**, and **Country/region** already in place, the next step is to include the **City** component.

To proceed, we click the **Add** button in the **Configure Address Component** section. This will allow us to select and include the **City** field, ensuring that the full structure of the address is correctly captured in the format. By doing this, we move closer to completing a comprehensive address layout.

With the **State or province**, **Zip/postal code**, and **Country/region** components added to the Faerûn address format, the next step is to include the **City** field. This is a crucial part of the address structure.

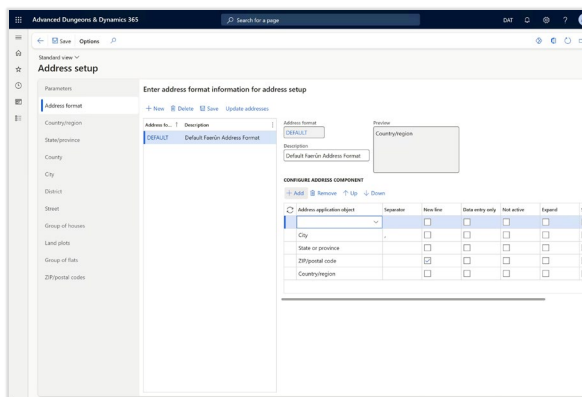
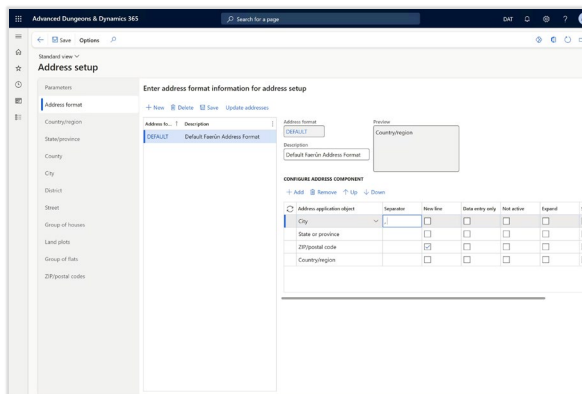
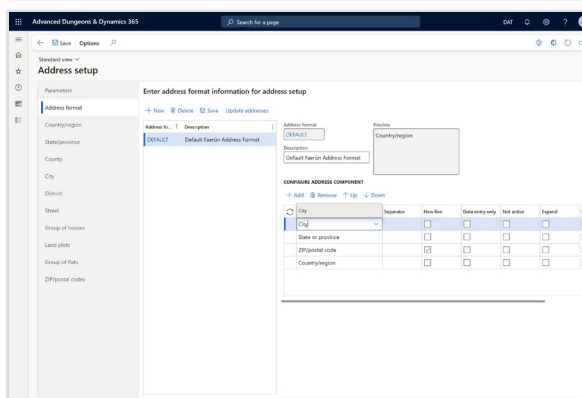
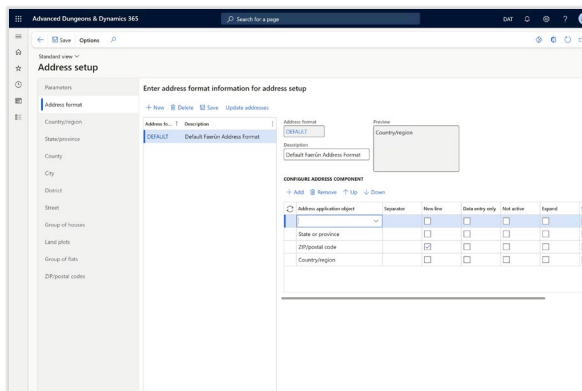
To add this component, we click on the **Address application object** dropdown list and select **City**. By doing so, we ensure that city information is captured within the address format, moving closer to completing the full address layout. Each component is now being systematically added, creating a robust and detailed address format for Faerûn.

As we continue to build the Faerûn address format, it's important to ensure that the components are clearly separated for readability. After adding the **City** component, we need to insert a comma between the **City** and **State or province** fields. This is a common convention in address formatting.

To achieve this, we enter a comma (,) in the **Separator** field for the **City** component. This ensures that when the address is displayed, the city and state are separated by a comma, creating a clear and well-structured format.

As we near the completion of the Faerûn address format, it's time to add additional components to ensure all relevant address details are captured. With **City**, **State or province**, **Zip/postal code**, and **Country/region** already in place, we now need to include the **District** component.

To do this, we click the **Add** button in the **Configure Address Component** section. This will allow us to select the **District** field, ensuring that all necessary address elements are available for accurate and detailed address formatting. By adding this component, we are creating a robust and comprehensive address structure.



As we continue refining the Faerûn address format, we add the **District** component to capture additional location details. This field is essential for ensuring that addresses are complete and provide the necessary level of specificity. To add the **District** component, we click on the **Address application object** dropdown list and select **District**. This step ensures that district information is included in the address format, further enhancing the accuracy and usability of the addresses entered in the system. Each new component brings us closer to finalizing a comprehensive address format.

As we finalize the configuration of the Faerûn address format, it's important to ensure that each component is properly organized for readability. After adding the **District** component, we want it to appear on a new line for clarity. To achieve this, we check the **New line** box for the **District** component. This ensures that when the address is displayed, the district will be positioned on a separate line, making the address more readable and visually structured. This step helps maintain a clear and organized layout for users entering or viewing addresses.

As we near the completion of the Faerûn address format, one final essential component remains: the **Street** field. This field is crucial for ensuring that the address is fully detailed and functional.

To add this final component, we click the **Add** button in the **Configure Address Component** section. By including the **Street** field, we ensure that the address format captures all critical information, providing a complete and structured layout for entering and displaying addresses in the system.

As we finalize the Faerûn address format, the last essential component to add is the **Street** field. This field ensures that every part of an address, from street names to district and postal codes, is captured in the format.

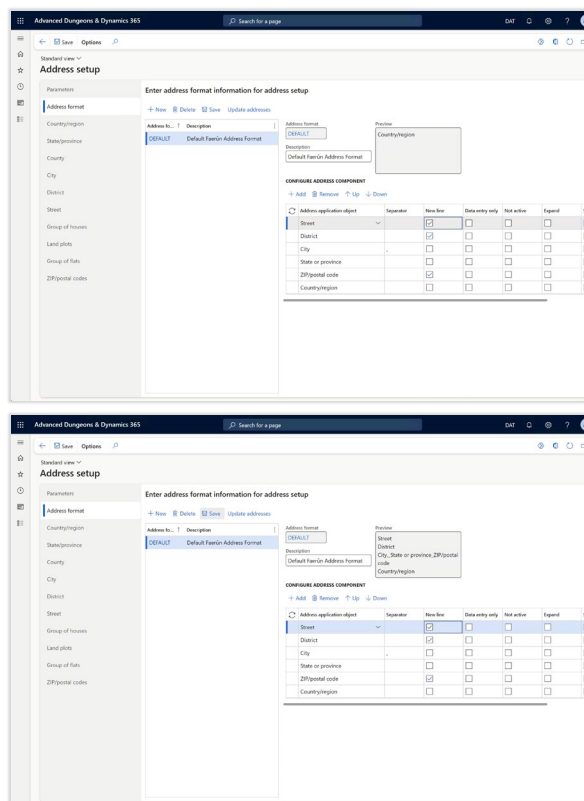
To add this final component, we click on the **Address application object** dropdown list and select **Street**. By doing so, we complete the address format, ensuring it is comprehensive and ready for use in capturing full address details within the system. Each component now works together to create a structured and functional format for Faerûn addresses.

As we finalize the Faerûn address format, it is important to maintain clarity and structure in the layout. After adding the **Street** component, we ensure that it appears on its own line for better readability.

To achieve this, we check the **New line** box for the **Street** component. This ensures that when addresses are displayed, the street information will be placed on a new line, keeping the format clean and easy to follow. By completing this step, we create a well-organized address format that captures all essential details clearly.

Now that we have configured all the components for the Faerûn address format, it's time to save our changes. The format now includes **Street**, **District**, **City**, **State or province**, **Zip/postal code**, and **Country/region**, ensuring that all key address details are captured.

To finalize and commit these changes, we click the **Save** button in the menu bar. Once saved, we will see a preview of the formatted address in the header section of the **Address format** page. This preview allows us to confirm that the address format appears exactly as intended, ensuring it's ready for consistent use across the system.



Result

After finalizing the configuration of the address format, we can now view the full setup in the **Address setup** page. The components we've added, which include **Street**, **District**, **City**, **State or province**, **ZIP/postal code**, and **Country/region**, are displayed in the **Configure address component** section. Each component has been carefully ordered, and we have ensured the appropriate separators and new line settings are applied.

At the top right, a **Preview** pane now shows how the address will be formatted in practice. The address format begins with **Street**, followed by **District**, and moves onto **City** and **State or province**, separated by a comma, before concluding with **ZIP/postal code** and **Country/region**. This preview gives us a visual confirmation that the address format is correctly configured.

The **Default Faerûn Address Format** is now ready for use in all relevant records, ensuring consistency in address formatting across the system.

Address setup

Enter address format information for address setup

+ New Delete Save Update addresses

Address format: DEFAULT

Description: Default Faerûn Address Format

Preview:

```
Street
District
City, State or province, ZIP/postal
code
Country/region
```

CONFIGURE ADDRESS COMPONENT

+ Add Remove Up Down

Address application object	Separator	New line	Data entry only	Not active	Expand	Sp
Street	,	☒	☐	☐	☐	[
District	,	☒	☐	☐	☐	[
City	,	☐	☐	☐	☐	[
State or province	,	☐	☐	☐	☐	[
ZIP/postal code		☒	☐	☐	☐	[
Country/region		☐	☐	☐	☐	[